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SUNDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Johnson's TIF plan faces some resistance

Aldermen complain about property tax sweep bid to balance budget

By A.D. Quig and Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

Mayor Brandon Johnson finds himself in an unexpected fight as he works to rally at least 26 votes to pass his \$16 billion 2026 spending plan. Though aldermen have agreed in every Chicago budget for the past decade to pull money out of tax increment financing districts around the city, both allies and opponents of the mayor on the City Council are voicing serious reservations about the bulk and breadth of this year's deficit-plugging standby.

The mayor's proposal to sweep a record \$1 billion out of the city's TIF piggy banks has even drawn criticism from Ald. Jason Ervin, the mayor's hand-picked budget shepherd, Ald. Michelle Harris, his Rules Committee chair, and Ald. Walter "Red" Burnett, his latest appointee to the council.

The sum is nearly double what the city surplused last year and would hit 68 of the city's 108 TIF districts, according to projections provided to aldermen.

By Ervin's estimate, more than half of the dollars would come out of "socially, economically disadvantaged areas," and potentially delay much-needed improvements in those TIF districts. He cast it as yet another example in a long history of the South and West sides getting short shrift.

To delay projects "for other communities that are not putting in their total share, in my opinion, is having the residents of the South and West sides ultimately have to bail out CPS when other communities are not having to pay that burden," Ervin said immediately after Johnson introduced his budget.

When the mayor touted the TIF surplus in his 2026 budget speech to aldermen, he could hardly have predicted it would turn into a racially charged front on which he would need to try to convince them to support him.

Turn to Budget, Page 5

INSIDE



ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/TRIBUNE

Loveland's chance at spotlight comes now

Is Colston Loveland ready for a breakout? With Cole Kmet out on Sunday, the Bears rookie tight end might get his chance against the Ravens. **Chicago Sports**

Trump's power grows in shutdown

The shutdown is quickly becoming a way for President Donald Trump to exercise new command over the government. It wasn't always this way. **Nation & World**

'Chill the hell out'

Chicago police in difficult spots as wave of federal immigration enforcement continues



A federal officer points a crowd control weapon out the window of a vehicle at protesters while Chicago police Cmdr. Lazaro Altamirano walks past as police clear the crowd Thursday after a raid at Discount Mall in Little Village. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

By Caroline Kubzansky and Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

Federal agents had just sped away from a working-class residential block in Chicago's East Side neighborhood when a white-shirted Chicago police officer took a deep breath, ducked under a running garden hose and stayed there for several moments. Tear gas still hung in the air and residents were still collecting themselves.

The officer scrubbed at his damp face. He was one of several supervisors who had stood to the side as a crowd of angry neighbors gathered around Border Patrol agents who crashed a car at the intersection of 105th Street

IN CHICAGOLAND: Agents deploy tear gas on Northwest Side streets as Chicagoans bellow, "Get out of our city!"

■ Greg Bovino ordered into court after feds defend using tear gas on residents in Little Village. **Stories on Page 3**

and Avenue N.

When people started to throw things, agents filled the block with riot control gas and drove off, leaving disoriented neighbors and police behind.

Chicago police have found themselves in a curious position as the Trump administration's Operation Midway Blitz has

Turn to Police, Page 4



Faith leaders decry Trump's mission of mass deportation

Local clergy have sharpened rhetoric, moving from supportive words for city's immigrant community to condemnation of DHS tactics

By Angie Leventis Lourgos
Chicago Tribune

Outside the Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility in Broadview, more than four dozen ministers gathered to pray for the detainees inside — and the repentance of federal agents who arrested them — during a Friday morning worship service attended by a crowd of more than 200.

"In the name of all things holy and good, liberation must be attained. We lift up a vision of compassion, mercy and love," said the Rev. Jason Lydon of Second Unitarian Church of Chicago. "Mercy, we cry. Freedom, we seek. Justice, we demand."

Clergy from different faiths hosted a liturgy or prayer service at the site each Friday during October, part of a growing

movement of religious leader opposition to the Trump administration's ongoing immigration crackdown. As the so-called Operation Midway Blitz enters its eighth week, local faith leaders have sharpened their rhetoric about the mass deportation mission, moving from supportive words for Chicago's immigrant community to condemnation of the Department of Homeland Security's tactics.

Chicago native Pope Leo XIV joined the chorus this week when, without specifically naming Chicago, he denounced the mistreatment of immigrants during an address. While nations have the right to protect their borders, "this should be balanced with the moral obligation to provide refuge," the pontiff said. "With the abuse of vulner-

Turn to Clergy, Page 6



Above: Dominican Sister Christin Tomy, left, serves Communion to members of a procession outside the Immigration and Customs Enforcement processing facility in Broadview after eucharistic ministers, including Tomy, attempted to serve Holy Communion to detainees Oct. 11 during the Coalition for Spiritual and Public Leadership's eucharistic procession. The procession marched from St. Eulalia Catholic Church in Maywood. **DOMINIC DI PALERMO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

At top: The Rev. Emily Heitzman, center, from Loyola University Chicago, and protesters participate in a flower ceremony during an interfaith prayer service led by North Shore Unitarian Church outside the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement holding facility in Broadview on Friday. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 60

Low 44

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 20

\$5.75 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 299 © Chicago Tribune

